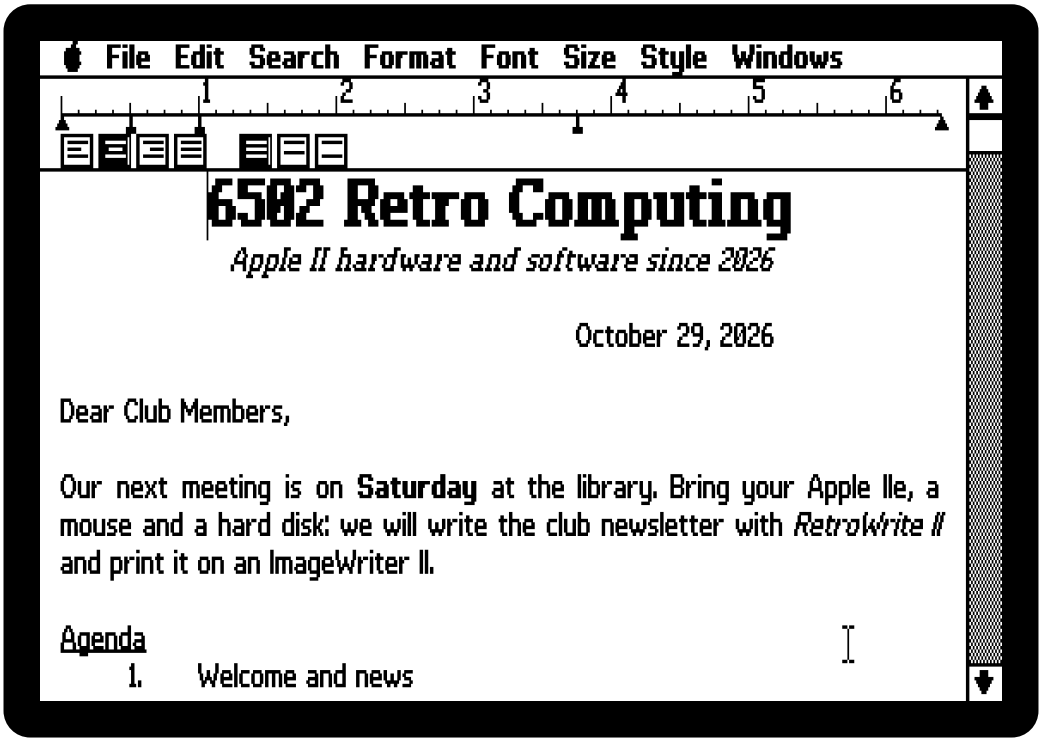
RetroWrite II

Word Processing for the Apple IIe

User's Manual



6502 RETRO COMPUTING

Version 2.1

6502 Retro Computing · 2026

For the enhanced Apple IIe with 128K, a mouse and a hard disk

An enthusiast program and manual, 2026

RetroWrite II is an independent word processor by 6502 Retro Computing, written in 2026 for Apple II enthusiasts. It is not a product of Apple, nor of the publishers of MultiScribe, MouseWrite or MacWrite.
This manual accompanies RetroWrite II version 2.1.

RetroWrite II

Word processing for the enhanced Apple IIe

User's Manual for version 2.1, 2026

RetroWrite II and this manual were written by 6502 Retro Computing in 2026 for Apple II enthusiasts. You may copy the program and this manual for your own use and share them with other Apple II users, free of charge.

Apple, Apple IIe, ProDOS, ImageWriter and Apple II DeskTop are names belonging to their owners. RetroWrite II is an independent program; it is not made or endorsed by Apple or by the publishers of MultiScribe, MouseWrite or MacWrite, whose way of working it follows.

Every screen picture in this manual was taken from RetroWrite II itself, running on an emulated Apple IIe.

Contents

Welcome to RetroWrite II 6

What you need 6

About this manual 6

1 Getting Started 7

Installing RetroWrite II 7

Starting RetroWrite II 7

The RetroWrite II screen 7

Using the mouse 8

Using the keyboard 8

Leaving RetroWrite II 8

2 A Quick Tour 9

Step 1: Type the text 9

Step 2: Center the heading 9

Step 3: Change fonts, sizes and styles 9

Step 4: Set tab stops for the date and the agenda 10

Step 5: Save the letter 10

Step 6: Print it 10

3 The Apple Menu 11

About RetroWrite II 11

Keyboard Help 12

Mouse Tutorial 12

Startup Preferences 12

Load DOS 3.3 File 13

Communications 13

BASIC.SYSTEM 14

4 The File Menu 15

New 15

Open 15

Close 16

Save 16

Save As 17

Save As Text . . . 17
Page Setup . . . 18
Print . . . 18
Print Several . . . 19
Quit . . . 19

5 The Edit Menu . . . 20

Cut . . . 20
Copy . . . 20
Paste . . . 21
Clear . . . 21
Select All . . . 21
Glossary . . . 21
Edit Glossary . . . 22

6 The Search Menu . . . 23

Find . . . 23
Find Next . . . 24
Replace . . . 24
Check Spelling . . . 25
Edit User Dictionary . . . 25

7 The Format Menu . . . 26

Show Ruler . . . 26
Using the ruler . . . 26
Align Left . . . 27
Center . . . 27
Align Right . . . 27
Justify . . . 27
Single, 1½ and Double Space . . . 27
Insert Page Break . . . 28

8 The Font Menu . . . 29

Sans, Serif, Mono . . . 29

9 The Size Menu . . . 30

9, 18 and 27 Point . . . 30

10 The Style Menu . . . 31

Plain Text . . . 31
Bold, Italic, Underline . . . 31

Superscript, Subscript 32

11 The Windows Menu 33

Switching windows 33

A Keyboard Summary 34

B Files and Folders 36

C Limits and Memory 37

D Messages 38

E The Document Format 39

Index 40

Welcome to RetroWrite II

RetroWrite II is a word processor for the enhanced Apple IIe, in the tradition of MacWrite, MultiScribe and MouseWrite. What you see on the screen is what you get on paper: three fonts, three sizes, bold, italic, underline, superscript and subscript, centered and justified paragraphs, tab stops and page breaks all show as you type, and print the same way on an ImageWriter II or an Epson printer.

You work with the mouse and pull-down menus, or with the keyboard: every menu can be opened with the Esc key, and the most used commands have an Open-Apple-key shortcut. RetroWrite II is made to live on a hard disk; the parts of the program that you use less often are read from the disk when you need them, which leaves room in memory for long documents.

What you need

- An enhanced Apple IIe (65C02) with 128K of memory (an extended 80-column card). It should also run on an Apple IIc or IIgs, but it was made and tested on the IIe.
- An AppleMouse or compatible mouse card: you need the mouse to select text, although every command can also be given from the keyboard.
- A hard disk, or a large disk image, with ProDOS 8. RetroWrite II takes about 600K including its dictionary.
- A monochrome monitor gives the sharpest text. A color monitor also works.
- For printing: an ImageWriter II or an Epson-compatible printer on a parallel or serial printer card.

About this manual

Chapter 1 tells you how to install and start RetroWrite II and introduces the screen. Chapter 2 is a short tour: you write, style and print a letter. Chapters 3 to 11 are the reference section, one chapter per menu, with an entry for every command. The appendices list every key, the files RetroWrite II uses, its limits and its messages, and there is an index at the back.

Each reference entry has the same parts, as in the Version Soft manuals:

Part	What it tells you
Definition	what the command does
What to do	the steps, with the mouse or the keyboard
Example	a short example
NOTE	things to know, limits, tips
See	related entries

Words in **`this type`** are what you type or what appears on the screen. Open-Apple is the Open-Apple key, at the left of the space bar: **Open-Apple-S** means hold down Open-Apple and press S. The Solid-Apple key (Solid-Apple, at the right of the space bar) works the same way.

1 Getting Started

This chapter explains how to install RetroWrite II on your hard disk, how to start it, and what you see on the screen.

Installing RetroWrite II

RetroWrite II comes installed on the disk image it was delivered on, in the folder **/DESKTOP/RETROWRITE**. To put it on another hard disk, copy the whole **RETROWRITE** folder there, for example with Apple II DeskTop. Everything RetroWrite II needs is in that folder; it finds the folder by itself wherever you put it.

On a PC you can also use the included installer, which copies the files into a disk image and adds RetroWrite II to Apple II DeskTop's Shortcuts menu:

```
python3 install_rw2.py MYDISK.po --ac ac.jar --files .
```

Starting RetroWrite II

In Apple II DeskTop, open the **RETROWRITE** folder and double-click **RW2.SYSTEM**, or choose RetroWrite II from the Shortcuts menu. From BASIC.SYSTEM type **-/DESKTOP/RETROWRITE/RW2.SYSTEM**; from a program selector such as Bitsy Bye, choose **RW2.SYSTEM**.

A welcome picture may appear for a few seconds while the program loads; press any key to go on. Then you see an empty, untitled document ready for typing.

RetroWrite II uses all of the Apple IIe's auxiliary memory, so it switches off the /RAM disk while it runs and switches it back on when you quit. If /RAM has files in it, RetroWrite II warns you first and lets you stop.

The RetroWrite II screen

Here is RetroWrite II with a letter on the screen and the ruler showing:



The RetroWrite II screen

The menu bar holds the menus: the Apple menu (), File, Edit, Search, Format, Font, Size, Style and Windows. **The ruler** (shown with -**H**) sets margins, tab stops, alignment and line spacing. **The text area** shows your document as it will print. **The scroll bar** at the right moves through a long document. **The pointer** follows the mouse: an arrow over the menus and the scroll bar, an I-beam over the text. **The caret**, a blinking line, shows where the next letter you type goes.

Using the mouse

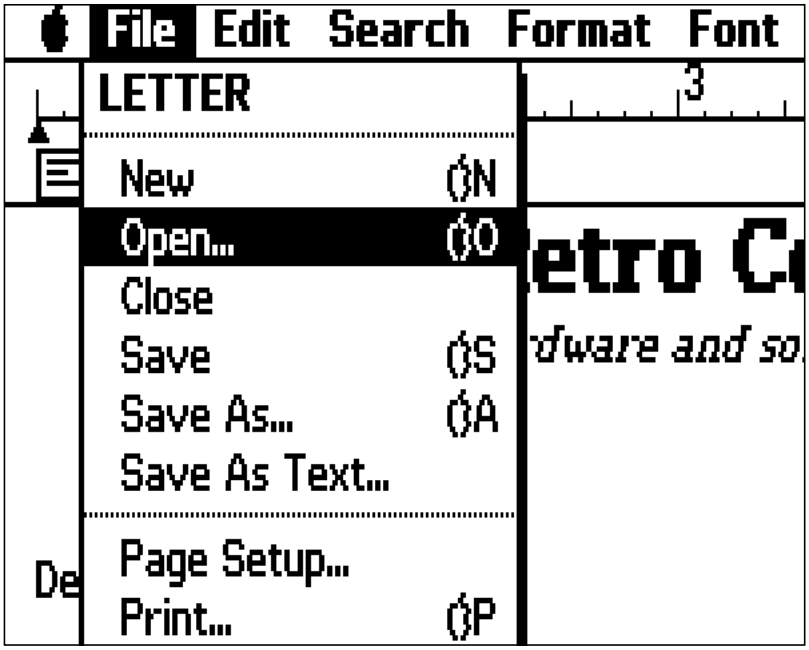
RetroWrite II works like the programs you may know from the Macintosh and the Apple IIgs:

- **Point** by moving the mouse. **Click**: press and release the button. **Double-click**: click twice quickly. **Drag**: hold the button down while you move the mouse.
- **Choosing from a menu:** point at a menu title, hold the button down, drag down to the command and let go. Or click the title once: the menu stays open until you click a command (or click outside to close it). Commands you can't use are dimmed; a check mark shows a setting that is on.
- **Placing the caret:** click in the text.
- **Selecting text:** drag across it. Double-click a word to select the word; keep the button down after the second click and drag to select whole words. Hold down ◌ or and click to extend a selection to the place you click.
- **Scrolling:** click a scroll arrow to move one line (hold it down to keep scrolling), click the gray area to move a page, or drag the scroll box.

Using the keyboard

Type as on a typewriter. You never press Return at the end of a line: RetroWrite II moves words to the next line by itself (word wrap). Press Return only to end a paragraph. The arrow keys move the caret; Delete erases the character before the caret, or the selected text.

Esc opens the menus from the keyboard. The File menu opens first; use the left and right arrows to move to another menu, the up and down arrows to choose a command, and Return to give it. Typing the first letter of a command also gives it. Press Esc again to close the menu. Appendix A lists every key.



The File menu, opened with Esc, with Open... chosen with the arrow keys

Leaving RetroWrite II

Choose Quit from the File menu (◌-**Q**). If a document has changes you haven't saved, RetroWrite II asks whether to save them. You return to the program you started RetroWrite II from, such as Apple II DeskTop.

2 A Quick Tour

In this chapter you write the short club letter shown below, give it fonts and styles, set its tabs, save it and print it. It takes about fifteen minutes. The finished letter is also in the **DOCUMENTS** folder, as **LETTER**, if you want to look at it first.



The finished letter

Step 1: Type the text

Start RetroWrite II; an empty document appears. Type the first line, **6502 Retro Computing**, and press Return. Type the second line and press Return twice. Then type the rest of the letter. Don't press Return inside a paragraph: let the words wrap by themselves. Press Return at the end of each paragraph and once more for an empty line.

If you make a mistake, press Delete to erase back to it, or click just after the mistake, press Delete and type the correction.

Step 2: Center the heading

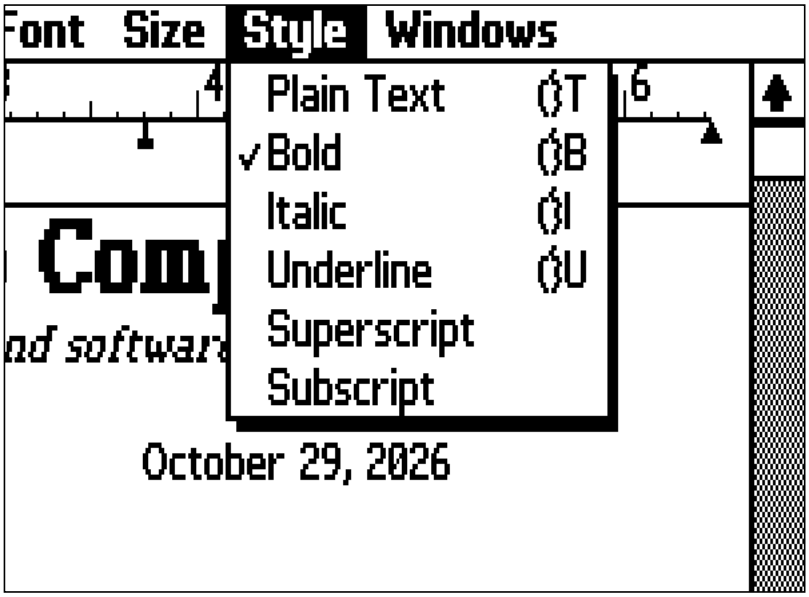
Click anywhere in the first line and choose **Center** from the Format menu (⌘-**E**). Do the same for the second line. Alignment belongs to the whole paragraph, so you don't need to select the text.

Step 3: Change fonts, sizes and styles

Drag across the first line to select it. Choose **Serif** from the Font menu, **18 Point** from the Size menu and **Bold** from the Style menu (⌘-**B**). Select the second line and choose Serif and **Italic** (⌘-**I**).

Double-click the word **Saturday** and press ⌘-**B** to make it bold. Select the word **Agenda** and choose **Underline** (⌘-**U**).

You can also choose the style before you type: with nothing selected, choose Bold, type the words, and choose **Plain Text** (⌘-**T**) to go back to normal letters.



The Style menu. The check mark shows the style of the selected text.

Step 4: Set tab stops for the date and the agenda

Choose **Show Ruler** from the Format menu (⌘-**H**). Click the ruler's scale at ½ inch and at 1 inch to put two tab stops there, and at about 3¾ inches for the date. Now click at the start of the date, press Tab three times, and the date moves to the third stop. In the agenda lines, press Tab before the number and again after it.

Click in the long paragraph and click the fourth alignment icon in the ruler (or choose **Justify**, ⌘-**J**) so that both of its edges are straight.

Step 5: Save the letter

Choose **Save** from the File menu (⌘-**S**). Because the letter has no name yet, the Save dialog appears. Type a name, such as **MYLETTER**, and click **Save**. The name appears at the top of the File menu and in the Windows menu.

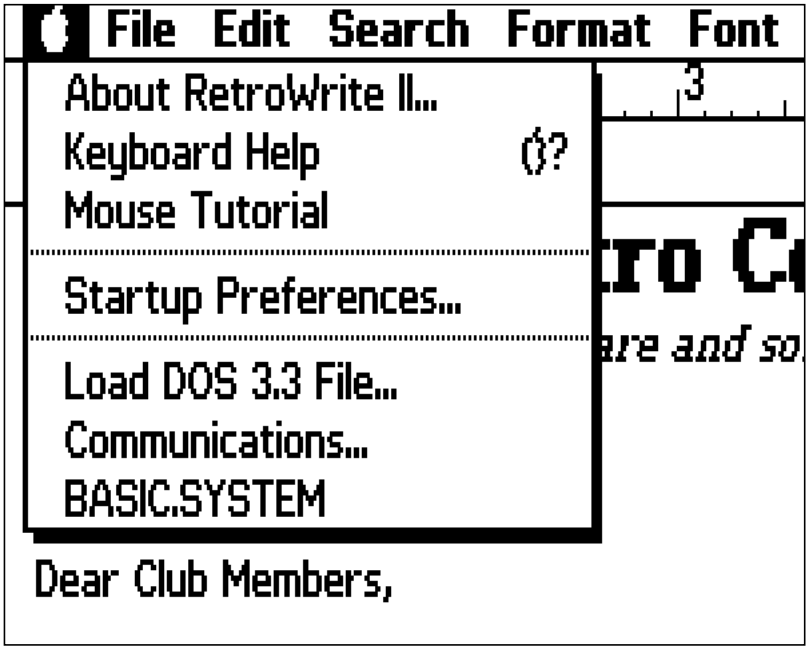
Step 6: Print it

Turn on your printer and choose **Print** from the File menu (⌘-**P**). The first time, click **Setup...** and choose your printer and the slot of its card, then click OK and choose Print again. RetroWrite II shows the page it is printing; press Esc to stop.

That's all there is to it. To see more, choose **Mouse Tutorial** from the Apple menu: it opens a document that shows each feature, which you can change as much as you like without harming the original.

3 The Apple Menu

The Apple menu, at the left end of the menu bar, holds information about RetroWrite II, the Mouse Tutorial, your Startup Preferences and the desk accessories: small programs you can use without leaving your work.



The Apple menu

About RetroWrite II

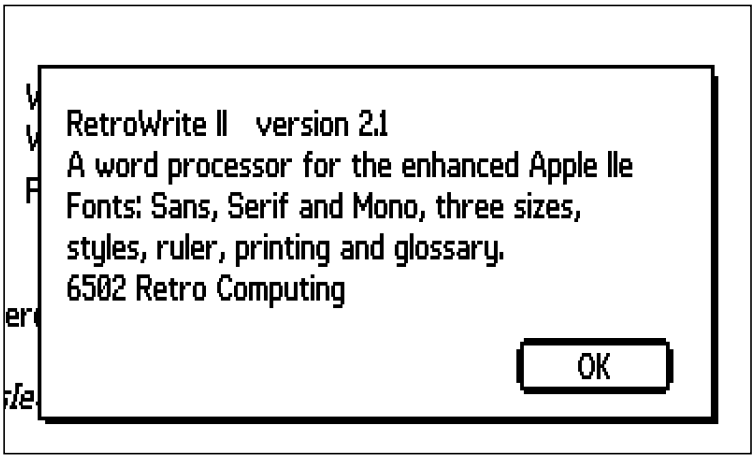
MENU: Apple

Definition Shows the version of RetroWrite II and who made it.

What to do

1. Choose About RetroWrite II... from the Apple menu.
2. Click OK (or press Return).

See Keyboard Help



About RetroWrite II

Keyboard Help

MENU: Apple **KEYS:** ⌘-?

Definition Shows a short list of the keyboard commands.

What to do

1. Choose Keyboard Help from the Apple menu, or press **⌘-?**.
2. Click OK when you have read it.

NOTE *You don't need to hold Shift: **⌘-/** works too. Appendix A has the full list.*

See Appendix A, Keyboard Summary

Mouse Tutorial

MENU: Apple

Definition Opens the TUTORIAL document: a guided tour of RetroWrite II that shows each feature in a real document.

What to do

1. Choose Mouse Tutorial from the Apple menu.
2. Read it, scroll with the scroll bar, and try things out in it.

NOTE *The tutorial opens as an untitled copy, so you can change it freely; the original file is never changed. If you save it, give it a new name.*

See Chapter 2, A Quick Tour

Startup Preferences

MENU: Apple

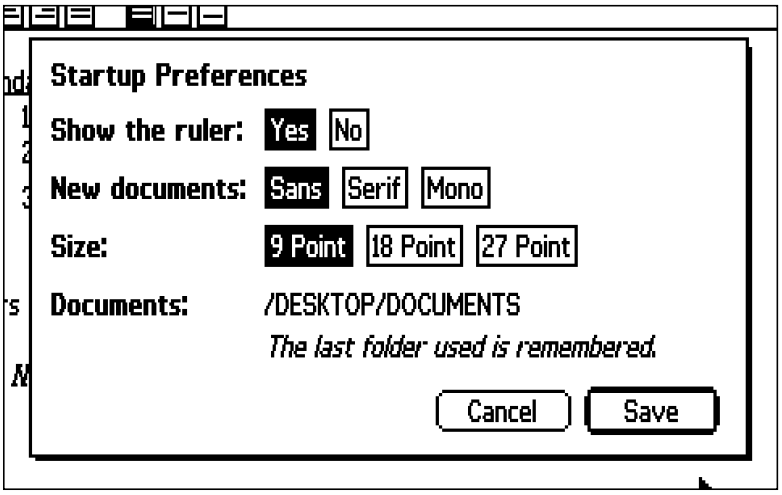
Definition Sets how RetroWrite II starts: whether the ruler shows, the font and size of new documents, the folder the Open and Save dialogs start in, and the printer settings from Page Setup. They are kept in the file **`RW2.PREFS`**.

What to do

1. Choose Startup Preferences... from the Apple menu.
2. Click the choices you want: **Show the ruler** Yes or No; **New documents** Sans, Serif or Mono; **Size** 9, 18 or 27 Point.
3. Click **Save** to keep them, or Cancel.

NOTE ***Documents** shows the folder the Open and Save dialogs will start in: the last folder you used. Clicking Save also keeps the printer, slot and print quality you chose in Page Setup, so set those first.*

See Page Setup; Show Ruler



Startup Preferences

Load DOS 3.3 File

MENU: Apple

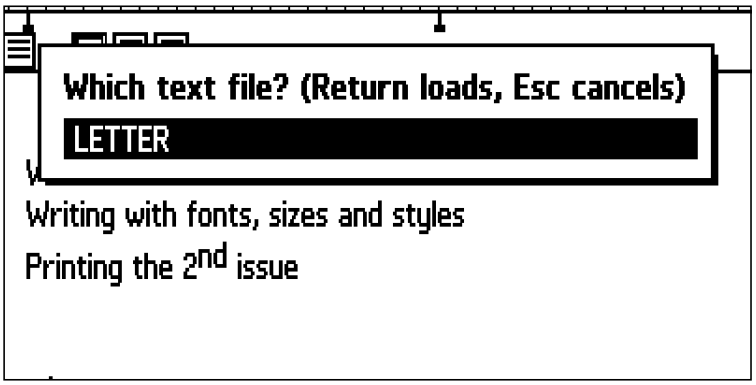
Definition Reads a text file from a DOS 3.3 disk in a 5.25-inch drive and puts it into your document at the caret. Use it for letters and notes you wrote years ago with DOS 3.3 programs or Applesoft.

What to do

1. Put the DOS 3.3 disk in drive 1 or 2 of the disk card in slot 6.
2. Click where the text should go in your document.
3. Choose Load DOS 3.3 File... from the Apple menu.
4. Click **S6 D1** or **S6 D2** for the drive.
5. The text files on the disk are listed. Click one and click it again, or use the arrow keys and press Return. Esc cancels.

NOTE *Only text files (DOS type T) are listed, up to 24. Lines end where the original had Return; the text takes the style of the text at the caret.*

See Open



Choosing a text file from a DOS 3.3 disk

Communications

MENU: Apple

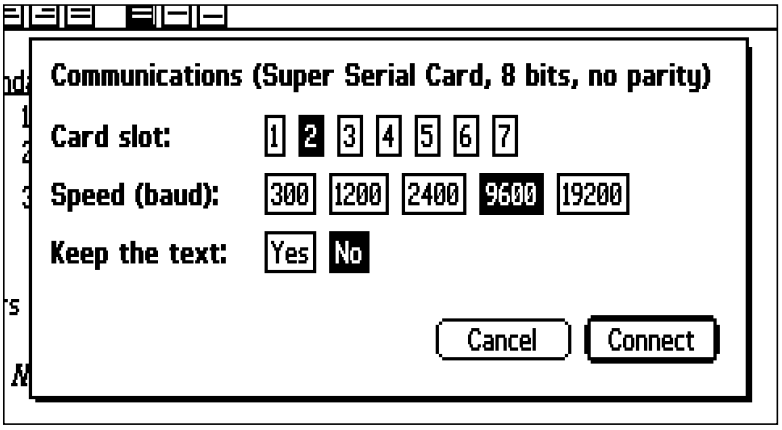
Definition Turns RetroWrite II into a simple terminal for a Super Serial Card, so you can talk to another computer or a modem. The text you receive can be kept in your document.

What to do

1. Choose Communications... from the Apple menu.
2. Click the **Card slot** of your Super Serial Card and the **Speed** (300, 1200, 2400, 9600 or 19200 baud).
3. Choose **Keep the text** Yes if what you receive should go into your document at the caret.
4. Click **Connect**. What you type is sent; what comes in is shown.
5. Press **⌘-.** (period) to end.

NOTE *The card is set to 8 data bits, no parity, 1 stop bit. If no Super Serial Card is in the slot you chose, RetroWrite II tells you so.*

See Startup Preferences



Communications settings

BASIC.SYSTEM

MENU: Apple

Definition Leaves RetroWrite II for Applesoft BASIC (BASIC.SYSTEM). When you type **BYE** in BASIC you come straight back to RetroWrite II.

What to do

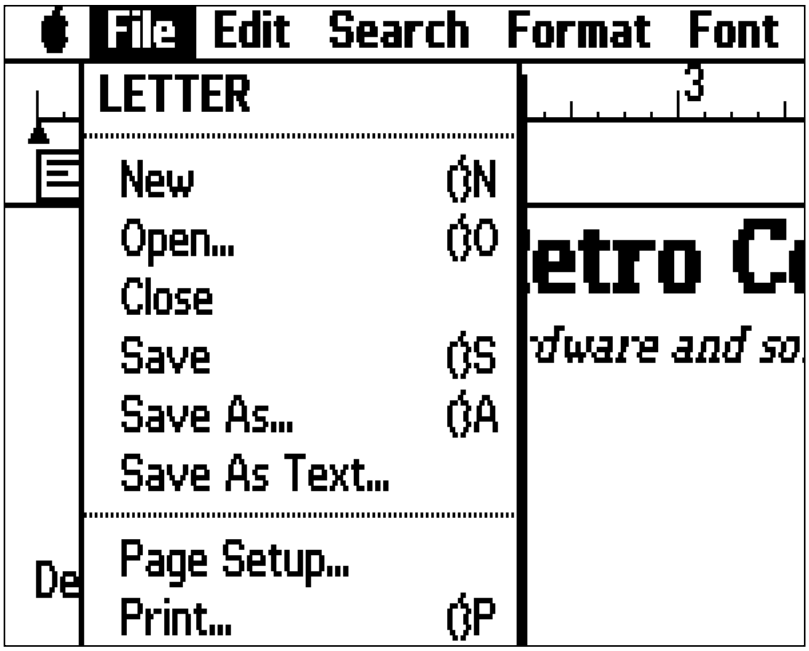
1. Choose BASIC.SYSTEM from the Apple menu.
2. If a document has unsaved changes, you are asked whether to save it.
3. Click **Go**. The BASIC prompt **]** appears.
4. When you are done, type **BYE** and press Return.

NOTE *RetroWrite II starts again with an empty document; open your document again with Open. BASIC.SYSTEM must be in the RETROWRITE folder or at the top level of the disk.*

See Quit

4 The File Menu

The File menu creates, opens, saves, prints and closes documents. Its first line shows the name of the document on the screen.



The File menu

New

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-N

Definition Starts a new, empty document called Untitled.

What to do

1. Choose New from the File menu, or press **⌘-N**.

NOTE *If the document on the screen has text in it, the new document opens in a new window and the old one stays open in the Windows menu (up to four documents). If all four windows are in use, you are asked whether to save the changes to the one on the screen, which the new document then replaces.*

See The Windows Menu; Close

Open

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-O

Definition Opens a RetroWrite II document or a text file from a disk.

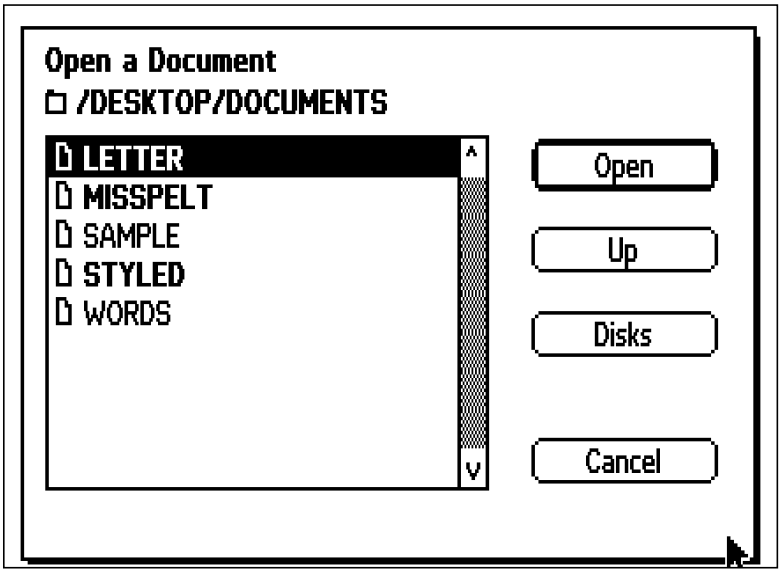
What to do

1. Choose Open... from the File menu, or press **⌘-O**.
2. The dialog lists the folders (■ folder icons) and documents (page icons) in the current folder. Click a document and click **Open**, or double-click it.
3. To open a folder, double-click it. Click **Up** to go to the folder that holds this one, and **Disks** to see all the disks.

Example To open the sample letter, press **⌘-O**, type **L** (the list jumps to the first name starting with L) and press Return.

NOTE *Keyboard: up and down arrows choose, right arrow or Return opens, left arrow goes up a folder, Esc cancels. Only folders, RetroWrite II documents and text files are listed, up to 48 per folder. A text file opens as plain text in Sans 9 point.*

See New; Save; Startup Preferences



The Open dialog

Close

MENU: File

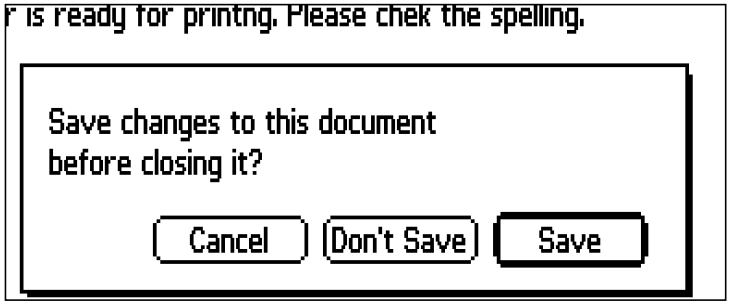
Definition Closes the document on the screen.

What to do

1. Choose Close from the File menu.
2. If there are changes, click **Save**, **Don't Save** or **Cancel**.

NOTE *If other documents are open, the next one comes on the screen. If it was the only one, you get an empty Untitled document.*

See The Windows Menu; Quit



Asked when a changed document would be closed

Save

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-S

Definition Saves the document on the screen under its name.

What to do

1. Choose Save from the File menu, or press **⌘-S**.

NOTE *If the document has no name yet, the Save As dialog appears. A document that came from a text file is saved as a text file again; if you have added fonts or styles to it, RetroWrite II asks whether to save it as a RetroWrite document (which keeps them) or as text. Save often!*

See Save As; Save As Text

Save As

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-A

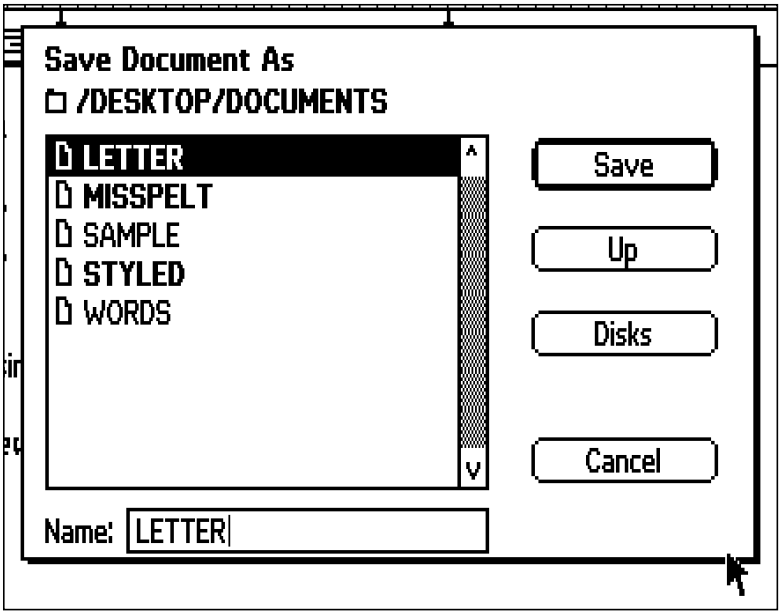
Definition Saves the document under a new name or in another folder, as a RetroWrite II document that keeps all fonts, styles, the ruler and the header and footer.

What to do

1. Choose Save As... from the File menu, or press **⌘-A**.
2. Open the folder you want, as in the Open dialog.
3. Type the name in the **Name** box (Delete erases). Clicking a document in the list copies its name.
4. Click **Save** or press Return.

NOTE *Names have up to 15 letters, digits and periods and start with a letter, as ProDOS requires. If a file with that name exists, you are asked whether to replace it. RetroWrite II documents are ProDOS type $50 with aux type $5257.*

See Save; Save As Text



The Save As dialog

Save As Text

MENU: File

Definition Saves the document as a plain ProDOS text file (TXT), which other programs such as AppleWorks, BASIC and Apple II DeskTop can read.

What to do

1. Choose Save As Text... from the File menu.
2. Choose the folder and type a name, then click Save.

NOTE *A text file can't keep fonts, sizes, styles, the ruler or page breaks; RetroWrite II warns you if the document has any. Each paragraph becomes one line ending with Return.*

See Save As

Page Setup

MENU: File

Definition Chooses your printer and how to print, and sets the header, footer and page numbers of the document.

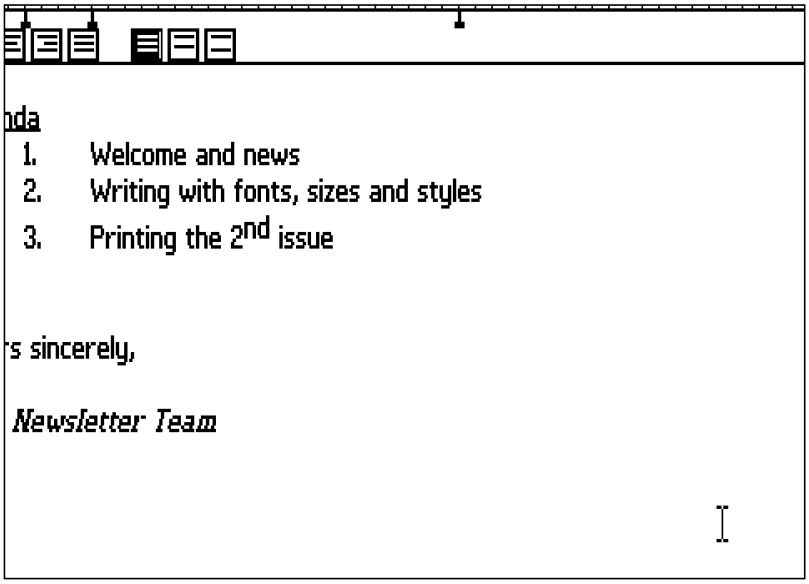
What to do

1. Choose Page Setup... from the File menu.
2. Click your **Printer**: ImageWriter II, Epson, or Plain text (any printer, no styles).
3. Click the **Slot** of the printer card.
4. Choose **Print**: **As on screen** prints in graphics, exactly as you see it; **Faster (printer's font)** uses the printer's own letters, with bold, underline, superscript and subscript.
5. **Page numbers** Yes prints `- 1 -` at the foot of each page when there is no footer.
6. Click the **Header** or **Footer** box to type a line printed at the top or bottom of every page. A # in it prints the page number.
7. Click **OK**.

Example A footer of `Club newsletter - page #` prints `Club newsletter - page 1`, `page 2` ...

NOTE *The header and footer are saved with the document. The printer, slot and print choices last until you quit; to keep them, click Save in Startup Preferences.*

See Print; Startup Preferences; Insert Page Break



Page Setup

Print

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-P

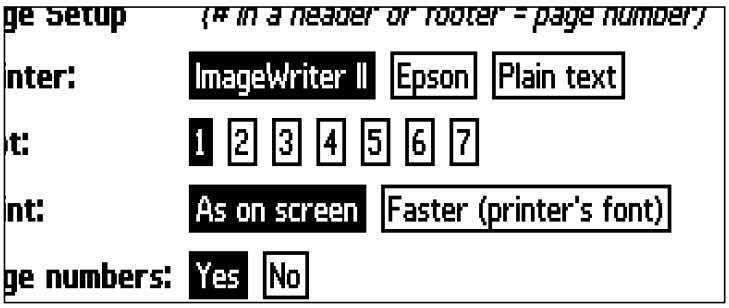
Definition Prints the document on the screen.

What to do

1. Turn on the printer and make sure it is selected (on line).
2. Choose Print... from the File menu, or press ⌘-P.
3. RetroWrite II names the printer and slot; click **Print**. Click **Setup...** to change them first.
4. A box shows the page being printed. Press Esc to stop.

NOTE *Pages are 11 inches long with the text 6.4 inches wide, like the ruler. Printing **As on screen** sends the page as graphics, which takes longer than **Faster**. If no printer card is in the slot, RetroWrite II says so.*

See Page Setup; Print Several



Before printing

Print Several

MENU: File

Definition Prints a series of documents, one after the other, without opening each one yourself.

What to do

1. Choose Print Several... from the File menu.
2. In the dialog, open the first document to print; it is printed.
3. The dialog appears again: choose the next one, and so on.
4. Click **Cancel** when you are done. Your own document comes back on the screen.

NOTE *All the documents are printed with the printer settings in Page Setup and each document's own header and footer.*

See Print

Quit

MENU: File **KEYS:** ⌘-Q

Definition Leaves RetroWrite II.

What to do

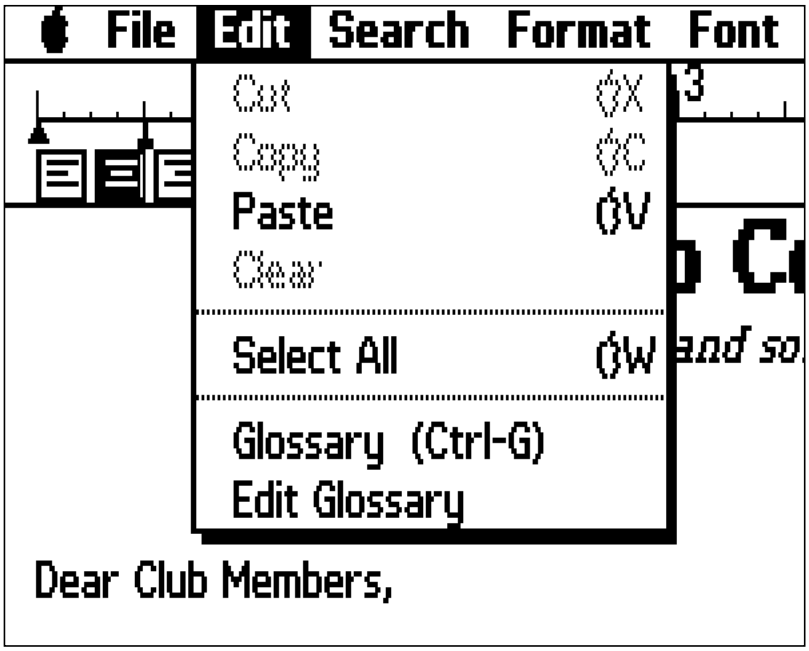
1. Choose Quit from the File menu, or press **⌘-Q**.
2. For each open document with unsaved changes, click Save or Don't Save (Cancel stops quitting).

NOTE *You return to the program that started RetroWrite II, such as Apple II DeskTop.*

See Close

5 The Edit Menu

The Edit menu moves and copies text through the clipboard, selects the whole document and types glossary entries for you.



The Edit menu

Cut

MENU: Edit **KEYS:** ⌘-X

Definition Removes the selected text and puts it on the clipboard, ready to paste.

What to do

1. Select the text.
2. Choose Cut from the Edit menu, or press **⌘-X**.

NOTE *The clipboard holds one piece of text at a time, with its fonts and styles. It is kept in the file* **`RW2.CLIPBOARD`***, so it is still there after you quit and start RetroWrite II again, or open another document.*

See Copy; Paste; Clear

Copy

MENU: Edit **KEYS:** ⌘-C

Definition Puts a copy of the selected text on the clipboard, leaving the document as it is.

What to do

1. Select the text.
2. Choose Copy from the Edit menu, or press **⌘-C**.

See Cut; Paste

Paste

MENU: Edit **KEYS:** ⌘-V

Definition Puts the text on the clipboard into the document at the caret, or in place of the selected text.

What to do
1. Click where the text should go, or select text to replace.
2. Choose Paste from the Edit menu, or press **⌘-V**.

Example To move a paragraph: select it, press **⌘-X**, click where it should go and press **⌘-V**.

NOTE *You can paste the same text as many times as you like.*

See Cut; Copy

Clear

MENU: Edit

Definition Removes the selected text without putting it on the clipboard.

What to do
1. Select the text.
2. Choose Clear from the Edit menu, or press Delete.

See Cut

Select All

MENU: Edit **KEYS:** ⌘-W

Definition Selects the whole document.

What to do
1. Choose Select All from the Edit menu, or press **⌘-W**.

Example To change the font of the whole document: press **⌘-W**, then choose the font.

See Using the mouse (chapter 1)

Glossary

MENU: Edit **KEYS:** Control-G

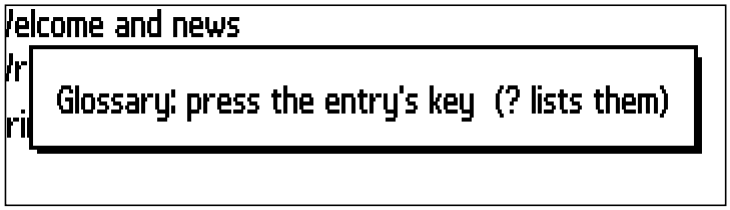
Definition Types a stored word or phrase for you. You give each phrase a one-key name in the glossary; Control-G and that key put it into your document at the caret.

What to do
1. Hold down Control and press G (or choose Glossary from the Edit menu).
2. A box asks for the entry's key. Press it. Esc cancels.

Example With the entry **`A=Apple IIe`** in the glossary, Control-G then **`A`** types **`Apple IIe`**.

NOTE *Press **?** instead of a key to see the list of keys. Letters can be typed in capitals or small letters. The text takes the current typing style. The glossary that comes with RetroWrite II has A, R, D, Y and S.*

See Edit Glossary



Waiting for the glossary key

Edit Glossary

MENU: Edit

Definition Opens the glossary file so you can add, change or remove entries.

What to do

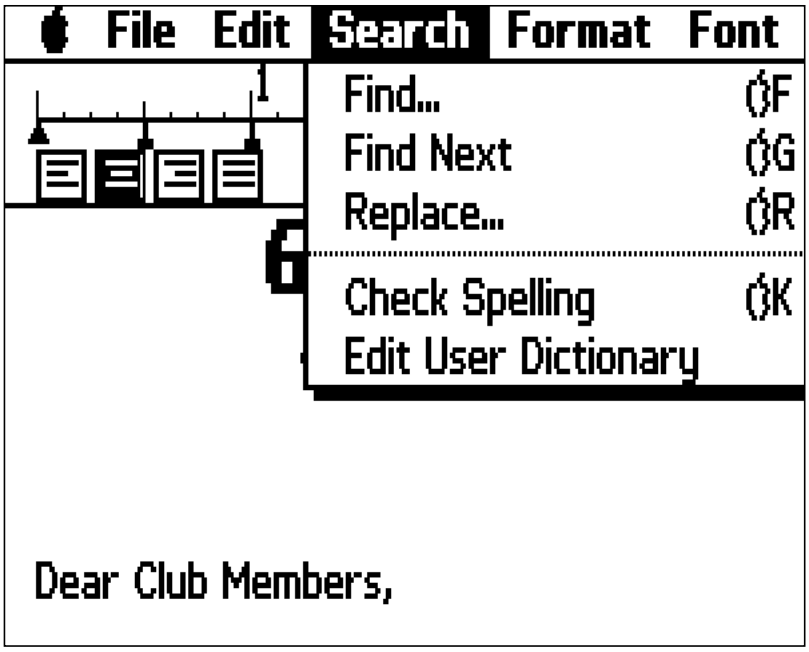
1. Choose Edit Glossary from the Edit menu. The **GLOSSARY** file opens as a text document.
2. Each line is one entry: the key, an equal sign and the text, such as **Y=Yours sincerely,**.
3. Change the lines, then choose Save (**-S**).

NOTE *Each entry fits on one line, up to about 190 characters. A key can be any letter, digit or sign. The file is in the RETROWRITE folder; if it doesn't exist, Edit Glossary starts a new one.*

See Glossary

6 The Search Menu

The Search menu finds and replaces words and checks your spelling.



The Search menu

Find

MENU: Search **KEYS:** ⌘-F

Definition Finds a word or phrase in the document and selects it.

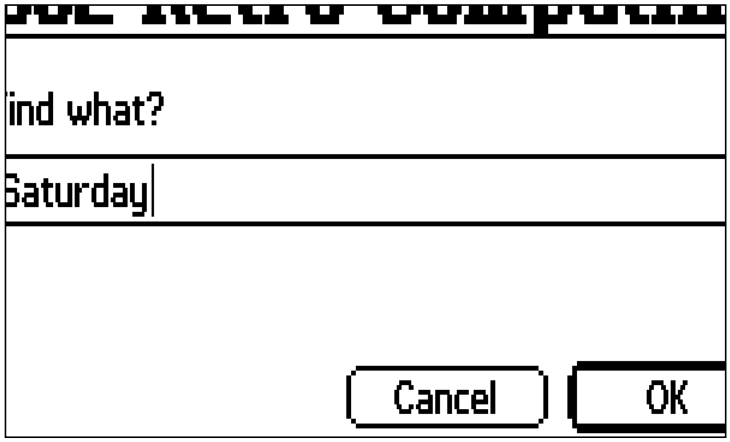
What to do

1. Choose Find... from the Search menu, or press ⌘-**F**.
2. Type what to find (up to 30 characters) and click OK or press Return. The box shows what you looked for last time; press Delete to erase it.

Example Find **`the`** finds **`The`**, **`the`** and **`weather`**.

NOTE *Find ignores capitals and fonts and also finds the letters inside longer words. It searches from the selection to the end, then from the top. If the text is not in the document, RetroWrite II says Not found.*

See Find Next; Replace



Find

Find Next

MENU: Search **KEYS:** ⌘-G

Definition Finds the next place with the same text you last looked for.

What to do **1.** Choose Find Next from the Search menu, or press **⌘-G**.

See Find

Replace

MENU: Search **KEYS:** ⌘-R

Definition Finds a word or phrase and replaces it with another, one by one or all at once.

What to do **1.** Choose Replace... from the Search menu, or press **⌘-R**.

2. Type what to find and press Return, then what to put in its place and press Return.

3. Each time the text is found, it is selected and you are asked: **Replace** replaces it and goes on, **All** replaces it everywhere in the document, **Stop** stops.

NOTE *At the end RetroWrite II tells you how many times it replaced the text. The replacement takes the style of the text it replaces.*

See Find



Replacing one at a time

Check Spelling

MENU: Search **KEYS:** ⌘-K

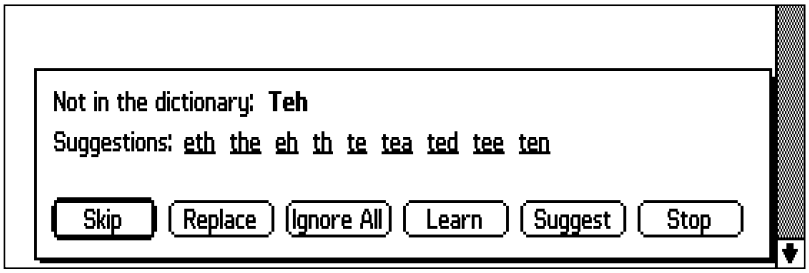
Definition Checks every word against the 460K dictionary SPELL.DICT and your own user dictionary, and shows you the words it doesn't know.

What to do

1. Click where checking should start (at the end of the document, it checks everything).
2. Choose Check Spelling from the Search menu, or press **⌘-K**.
3. For each unknown word, which is selected in your text, click:
4. **Skip** to leave it; **Replace** to type the correct word; **Ignore All** to skip it everywhere until you quit; **Learn** to add it to your user dictionary; **Suggest** (or press G) to see likely words; **Stop** (or Esc) to stop.
5. To use a suggestion, click it or press its number, 1 to 9.

NOTE *A replacement keeps the capitals of the original word. When the end is reached, you can go on from the top. Words with digits are skipped.*

See Edit User Dictionary



An unknown word, with suggestions

Edit User Dictionary

MENU: Search

Definition Opens your user dictionary, USER.DICT, the list of words you taught the spelling checker with Learn.

What to do

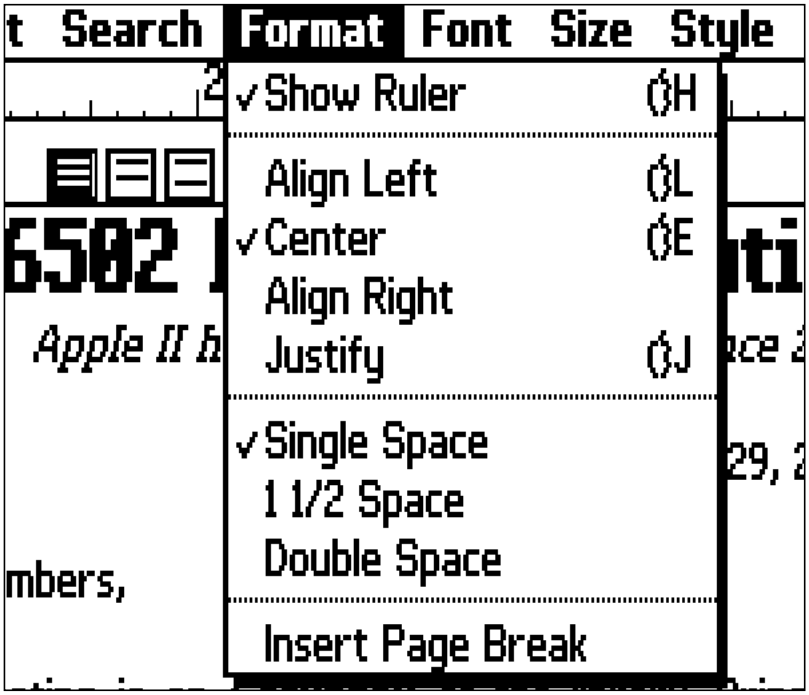
1. Choose Edit User Dictionary from the Search menu.
2. The words appear one to a line. Change, add or remove words.
3. Choose Save (**⌘-S**).

NOTE *Words are kept in small letters. Names and special words you use often are good to add here.*

See Check Spelling

7 The Format Menu

The Format menu and the ruler shape your paragraphs: margins, tab stops, alignment, line spacing and page breaks. Margins and tab stops belong to the whole document. Alignment and spacing belong to each paragraph: they apply to the paragraph with the caret, or to every paragraph in the selection.



The Format menu

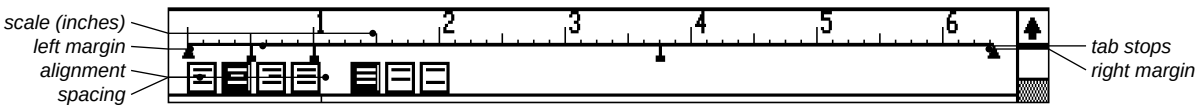
Show Ruler

MENU: Format **KEYS:** ⌘-H

Definition Shows or hides the ruler at the top of the window.

What to do **1.** Choose Show Ruler from the Format menu, or press **⌘-H**. A check mark shows when the ruler is on; choose it again to hide the ruler.

See The ruler (below); Startup Preferences



The ruler

Using the ruler

The scale is marked in inches, from 0 to 6.4. The two triangles under it are the left and right margins; the small marks are tab stops.

- **Margins:** drag a triangle left or right. The margins are at least ½ inch apart.
- **A new tab stop:** click the scale where you want it. You can have up to 8.
- **Moving a tab stop:** drag it along the scale.
- **Removing a tab stop:** drag it down off the ruler.
- **Alignment:** click one of the four icons: left, centered, right or justified.

• **Line spacing:** click one of the three icons: single, 1½ or double.

Positions snap to 1/16 inch. Pressing Tab moves to the next tab stop; past the last one, or if there are none, it moves to the next ½ inch. The ruler is saved with the document.

Align Left

MENU: Format **KEYS:** ⌘-L

Definition Lines up the paragraph's lines at the left margin, with a ragged right edge. This is how new paragraphs start.

What to do
1. Click in the paragraph (or select several).
2. Choose Align Left from the Format menu, press ⌘**-L**, or click the first alignment icon in the ruler.

See Center; Align Right; Justify

Center

MENU: Format **KEYS:** ⌘-E

Definition Centers each line of the paragraph between the margins. Use it for titles and headings.

What to do
1. Click in the paragraph.
2. Choose Center from the Format menu or press ⌘**-E**.

See Align Left

Align Right

MENU: Format

Definition Lines up the paragraph's lines at the right margin, for dates and addresses at the right side of a letter.

What to do
1. Click in the paragraph.
2. Choose Align Right from the Format menu.

See Align Left

Justify

MENU: Format **KEYS:** ⌘-J

Definition Spreads the words of each line so both edges of the paragraph are straight, as in a book. The last line of the paragraph stays at the left.

What to do
1. Click in the paragraph.
2. Choose Justify from the Format menu or press ⌘**-J**.

See Align Left

Single, 1½ and Double Space

MENU: Format

Definition Sets the space between the lines of the paragraph.

What to do
1. Click in the paragraph or select several.
2. Choose Single Space, 1 1/2 Space or Double Space from the Format menu, or click a spacing icon in the ruler.

NOTE *Double spacing is handy for drafts that others will mark up on paper.*

See Using the ruler

Insert Page Break

MENU: Format

Definition Makes the text after the caret start on a new page when you print.

What to do

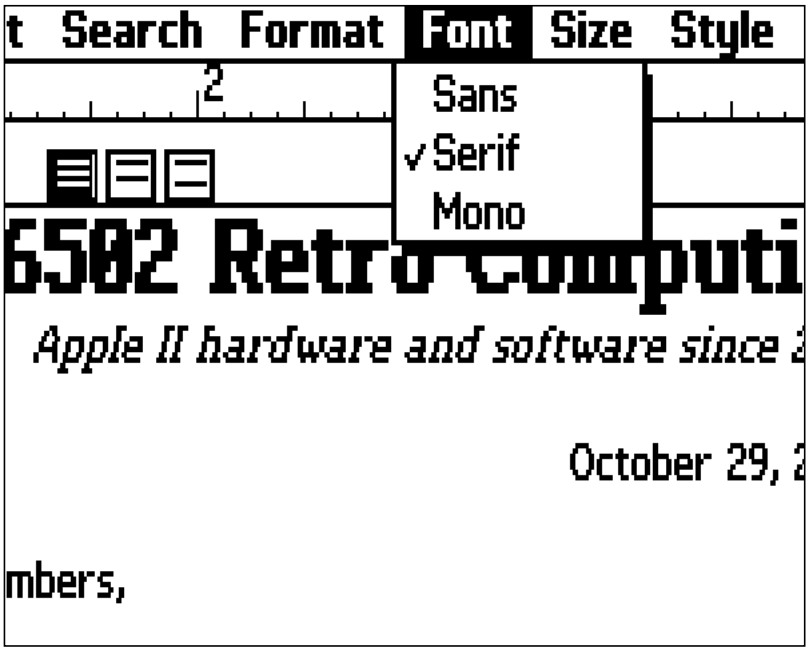
1. Click where the new page should start.
2. Choose Insert Page Break from the Format menu.

NOTE *A page break shows as a dotted line across the window. To remove it, click just after it and press Delete. Without page breaks, RetroWrite II starts a new page when one is full.*

See Print

8 The Font Menu

RetroWrite II has three fonts, all designed for the Apple IIe's double hi-res screen and printed as you see them.



The Font menu

Font	Looks like	Good for
Sans	clean letters without serifs	most writing, headings
Serif	letters with small serifs, like a book	letters, reports, titles
Mono	every letter the same width, like a typewriter	tables, lists that must line up, program listings

Sans, Serif, Mono

MENU: Font

Definition Changes the font of the selected text, or of the text you type next.

What to do

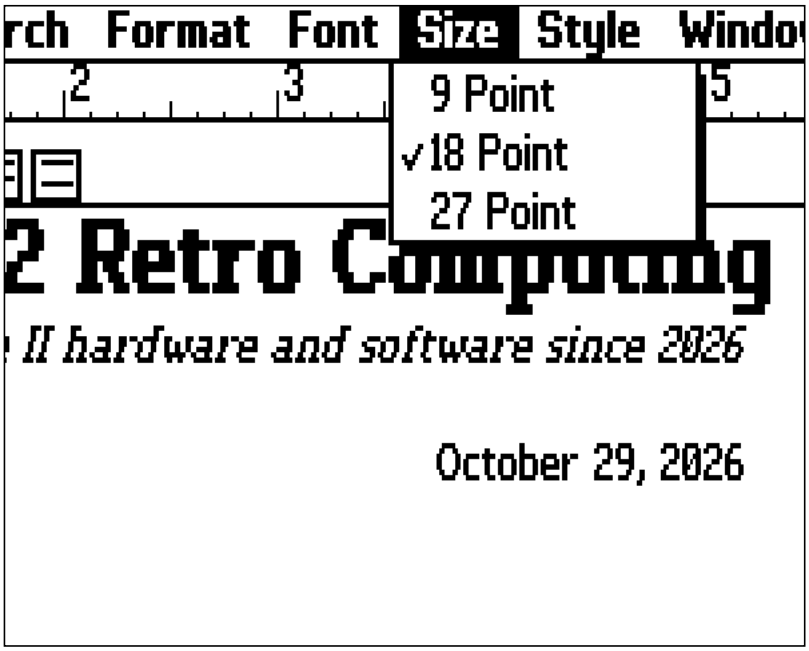
1. Select the text (or, to choose the font for what you type next, just put the caret where you will type).
2. Choose Sans, Serif or Mono from the Font menu.

NOTE *The check mark shows the font at the start of the selection. The font for new documents is set in Startup Preferences.*

See The Size Menu; The Style Menu; Startup Preferences

9 The Size Menu

Each font comes in three sizes. 18 and 27 point are the 9 point letters drawn two and three times as large, for headings and titles.



The Size menu

9, 18 and 27 Point

MENU: Size

Definition Changes the size of the selected text, or of the text you type next.

What to do

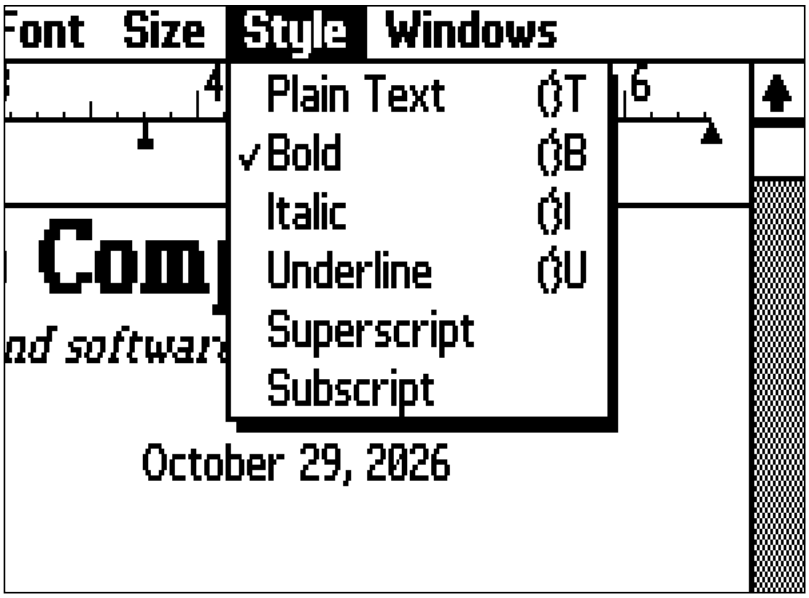
1. Select the text.
2. Choose 9 Point, 18 Point or 27 Point from the Size menu.

NOTE *A line is as tall as its largest letters. With Faster printing, 18 and 27 point print as wide printer letters.*

See The Font Menu

10 The Style Menu

Styles change the look of letters in any font and size. You can combine bold, italic and underline.



The Style menu

Plain Text

MENU: Style **KEYS:** ⌘-T

Definition Removes bold, italic, underline, superscript and subscript from the selection.

What to do
1. Select the text.
2. Choose Plain Text from the Style menu or press **⌘-T**.

See Bold, Italic, Underline

Bold, Italic, Underline

MENU: Style **KEYS:** ⌘-B ⌘-I ⌘-U

Definition Makes letters heavier, slanted, or underlined. Each command turns its style on for the selection, or off if the selection already has it.

What to do
1. Select the text.
2. Choose Bold, Italic or Underline from the Style menu, or press **⌘-B**, **⌘-I** or **⌘-U**.

Example Press **⌘-B**, type **`important`**, press **⌘-B** again, and type on: only the word is bold.

NOTE *With nothing selected, the style applies to what you type next. Check marks show the styles of the selected text.*

See Plain Text

Superscript, Subscript

MENU: Style

Definition Makes small letters raised above the line (superscript), as in E=mc² or 2nd, or lowered below it (subscript), as in H_2O.

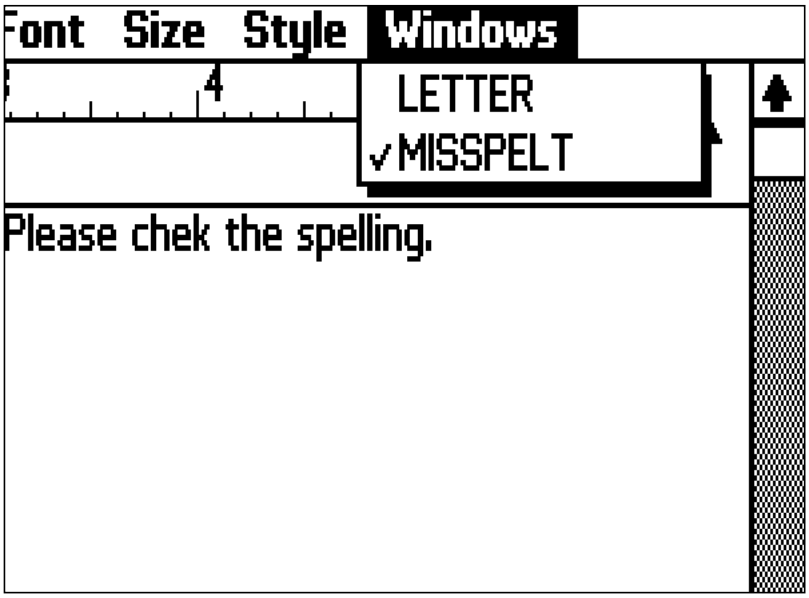
What to do

1. Select the characters.
2. Choose Superscript or Subscript from the Style menu.
3. To go back to normal letters, choose Plain Text.

See Plain Text

11 The Windows Menu

RetroWrite II can have up to four documents open at once. One is on the screen; the others wait in the Windows menu. You can copy and paste between them.



The Windows menu

Switching windows

MENU: Windows

Definition Brings another open document onto the screen.

What to do

1. Open the Windows menu: it lists the open documents, with a check mark beside the one on the screen.
2. Choose the document you want.

NOTE *New and Open use a new window when the document on the screen has something in it. While a document is not on the screen, it waits on the hard disk in a file named* **`RW2.WIN0`** *to* **`RW2.WIN3`** *in the RETROWRITE folder, with all its changes, so no extra memory card is needed.*

See New; Open; Close

A Keyboard Summary

Hold ⌥ (Open-Apple) or (Solid-Apple) and press the key shown.

Keys	Command	Keys	Command
⌥-N	New	⌥-H	Show Ruler
⌥-O	Open	⌥-L	Align Left
⌥-S	Save	⌥-E	Center
⌥-A	Save As	⌥-J	Justify
⌥-P	Print	⌥-T	Plain Text
⌥-Q	Quit	⌥-B	Bold
⌥-X	Cut	⌥-I	Italic
⌥-C	Copy	⌥-U	Underline
⌥-V	Paste	⌥-?	Keyboard Help
⌥-W	Select All	Control-G	Glossary
⌥-F	Find	Esc	open the menus
⌥-G	Find Next		
⌥-R	Replace		
⌥-K	Check Spelling		

Moving and editing

Keys	What they do
← →	one character left or right
↑ ↓	one line up or down
⌥← ⌥→	one word left or right
⌥↑ ⌥↓	one screen up or down
⌥1 ⌥9	to the top or the end of the document
Return	end the paragraph
Tab	to the next tab stop
Delete	erase the character before the caret, or the selection
⌥-Delete	erase the character after the caret

Menus and dialogs

Keys	What they do
Esc	open the menus (File first); in a menu: close it
← → in a menu	the menu to the left or right
↑ ↓ in a menu	choose a command
Return	give the chosen command; in a dialog: the button with the heavy border
a letter in a menu	the command that starts with that letter
a letter in a dialog	the button that starts with that letter (not in a dialog with a box you type into)
Esc in a dialog	Cancel (or Stop)

Mouse

Action	What it does
click	place the caret
drag	select text
double-click	select a word
double-click and drag	select whole words
⌥ or ⌘ click	extend the selection
click a menu title	open the menu (it stays open)

B Files and Folders

Everything RetroWrite II uses is in one folder, normally **/DESKTOP/RETROWRITE**. Keep these files together; RetroWrite II finds the folder by itself.

File	What it is
RW2.SYSTEM	the program you start; shows the welcome picture
RW2.MAIN	the main part of the program
RW2.LC, **RW2.FONTS**	more of the program, and the fonts
RW2.OVL1 - **RW2.OVL7**	parts read from the disk when needed: files, spelling, editing, menus, printing, desk accessories, dialogs
RW2.SPLASH	the welcome picture
SPELL.DICT	the dictionary (460K)
TUTORIAL	the Mouse Tutorial document
GLOSSARY	your glossary (a text file)
BASIC.SYSTEM	for Apple menu → BASIC.SYSTEM (optional)

These files are made as you work:

File	What it is
USER.DICT	your own words for the spelling checker (Learn)
RW2.PREFS	your Startup Preferences
RW2.CLIPBOARD	the clipboard
RW2.WIN0 - **RW2.WIN3**	documents waiting in other windows
RW2.QUIT	only while you are in BASIC.SYSTEM

Your documents can be anywhere. The disk that comes with RetroWrite II has a **DOCUMENTS** folder, where the Open and Save dialogs start the first time.

C Limits and Memory

RetroWrite II runs in an Apple IIe with 128K. It keeps your document in the auxiliary 64K and reads the less-used parts of the program from the hard disk.

	Limit
Length of a document	30,460 characters (about 15 typed pages)
Open documents	4 (in the Windows menu)
Width of the text	6.4 inches; margins at least ½ inch apart
Tab stops	8 (then every ½ inch)
Fonts and sizes	3 fonts, 3 sizes, bold, italic, underline, superscript, subscript
Header and footer	39 characters each
Find and Replace text	30 characters
Glossary entry	about 190 characters
File names	15 characters (ProDOS)
Files listed in a folder	48
Undo	there is no Undo: save often, and save copies of important work

Speed. On a 1 MHz Apple IIe, typing a letter takes about a quarter of a second to show and a new screen of text about three seconds. Typing never loses letters: if you type faster than the screen, RetroWrite II catches up when you pause. An accelerator card makes it much quicker.

D Messages

These are the messages RetroWrite II can show, in alphabetical order, and what to do about them.

Message	What to do
A file with that name already exists. Replace it?	Click Replace to write over it, or Cancel and type another name.
A hidden document could not be read back.	A RW2.WINn file was damaged or removed. The window starts empty; open the document again.
A text file can't keep fonts, sizes or styles. Save it as text anyway?	Click Save to lose the formatting in the text file, or Cancel and use Save As.
BASIC.SYSTEM was not found.	Copy BASIC.SYSTEM into the RETROWRITE folder or the top level of the disk.
Can't load part of RetroWrite II (RW2.OVLn is missing).	A program file is missing from the RETROWRITE folder. Copy the folder again.
Can't open the document / Can't put the document away	The disk is full, write-protected or offline. ProDOS's error is shown with it.
Names are 1-15 letters, digits or periods, starting with a letter.	Type a ProDOS name, such as LETTER.2.
No printer card was found in slot n.	Choose the right slot in Page Setup.
Not found.	Find didn't find the text anywhere in the document.
RW2.LC or RW2.FONTS is missing from the RetroWrite II folder.	Copy the RETROWRITE folder again.
RetroWrite II needs an Apple IIe with 128K.	The computer needs 128K (an extended 80-column card).
Save changes to this document before closing it?	Save keeps your work; Don't Save throws the changes away; Cancel goes back.
SPELL.DICT was not found / is damaged	Copy SPELL.DICT into the RETROWRITE folder again.
That disk is not a DOS 3.3 disk (or there is no disk in the drive).	Check the disk and the drive, then try again.
The document is full.	The document has 30,460 characters. Split it into two documents.
There is no GLOSSARY file in the RetroWrite II folder.	Choose Edit Glossary to make one.
There is no Super Serial Card in slot n.	Choose the right slot in Communications.
This document came from a text file, which can't keep fonts and styles.	Click RetroWrite to save a RetroWrite document (with a new name), or Text to save plain text.
This document is too large for RetroWrite II.	The file has more than 30,460 characters.
This is not a RetroWrite II document.	The file is another program's document. Text files open directly.
/RAM contains files that RetroWrite II will erase.	Press N, copy the files from /RAM to a disk, and start again; or press Y to go on.

E The Document Format

For programmers: how a RetroWrite II document is stored on disk. Documents are ProDOS files of type $50 with aux type $5257 (“RW”).

Bytes	Contents
0-3	**`RW2D`**
4	version: 3
5-6, 7-8	left and right margin, in screen pixels from the text’s left edge (80 per inch)
9-24	eight tab stops, the same units, 0 = none
25-64, 65-104	header and footer, ASCII, ending with 0
105 -	the text

The text is ASCII with Return ($0D) between paragraphs and Tab ($09). Bytes $80 and above are format marks that apply to the text after them:

Byte	Meaning
$80 + f	character format f: bits 0-1 font (0 Sans, 1 Serif, 2 Mono), bits 2-3 size (0 9pt, 1 18pt, 2 27pt, 3 superscript; with bold set, subscript), bit 4 bold, bit 5 italic, bit 6 underline
$83 + p	paragraph mark at the start of a paragraph: bits 2-3 alignment (left, center, right, justify), bits 4-5 spacing (single, 1½, double)

Index

/

/RAM 7

A

About RetroWrite II 11
Align Left 27
Align Right 27
alignment 27
Apple II DeskTop 7

B

BASIC.SYSTEM 14
Bold 31
BYE 14

C

Center 27
Check Spelling 25
Clear 21
clicking 8
clipboard 20
Close 16
Communications 13
Control-G 21
Copy 20
Cut 20

D

documents folder 36
DOS 3.3 disks 13
Double Space 27
dragging 8

E

Edit Glossary 22
Edit User Dictionary 25
Esc key 8

F

file dialog 15
file names 17
Find 23
Find Next 24
fonts 29

G

Glossary 21

H

headers and footers 18

I

Insert Page Break 28
installing 7
Italic 31

J

Justify 27

K

keyboard 8, 34
Keyboard Help 12

L

limits 37
line spacing 27
Load DOS 3.3 File 13

M

margins 26
memory 37
messages 38
Mono 29
mouse 8
Mouse Tutorial 12

N

New 15

O

Open 15

P

page breaks 28
page numbers 18

Page Setup 18
Paste 21
Plain Text 31
point sizes 30
Print 18
Print Several 19
printers 18
printing 18
pull-down menus 8

Q

Quit 19
quitting 8, 19

R

Replace 24
ruler 26

S

Sans 29
Save 16
Save As 17
Save As Text 17
screen 7
searching 23, 24
Select All 21
selecting text 21
Serif 29
Show Ruler 26
sizes 30
SPELL.DICT 25
spelling checker 25
starting RetroWrite II 7
Startup Preferences 12
styles 31
Subscript 32
Super Serial Card 13
Superscript 32

T

tab stops 26
terminal 13
text files 15, 17

U

Underline 31
USER.DICT 25

W

windows 33
Windows menu 33